Voice Dictation

Hold a key, speak English or Hungarian, release — the text is on your clipboard, ready to paste with ⌘**V** anywhere.

Hold	Language	Then
Right ⌥ (Option)	English	Release, wait ~1 s, press ⌘**V**
Right ⌘ (Command)	Hungarian	Release, wait ~1 s, press ⌘**V**

Speech recognition runs **entirely on your Mac** (OpenAI's Whisper model). No account, no API key, no cost — and after the one-time download it works fully offline. Your voice never leaves your computer.

What you need

Requirement	Details
Mac with Apple Silicon	M1, M2, M3, M4 or newer (not Intel). Check: Apple menu → About This Mac → Chip.
Free disk space	About 3 GB (the speech model is 1.6 GB).
Internet	Only during installation.
Time	10–15 minutes, mostly waiting for downloads.

Setup, step by step

1 Open Terminal

Press ⌘ **Space**, type **Terminal** and press **Enter**. A window with a text prompt opens. You will only need it for setup.

2 Paste the install command

Copy the whole block below, paste it into Terminal (⌘**V**) and press **Enter**:

```
cd ~ && git clone https://github.com/zsocavagyok/voice-dictation.git \
  && cd voice-dictation && ./install.sh \
  && open ~/Applications/"Voice Dictation.app"
```

> **A window asks to install “Command Line Tools”?** Click **Install**, wait until it finishes (a few minutes), then paste the command from this step again.

3 Wait for the installation

The installer downloads Python (if needed), the required libraries and the speech model (~1.6 GB). You'll see progress lines starting with ==>. It's finished when it prints `Done!` and the app opens.

4 Allow the two permissions

On first start macOS asks for permission for **“Voice Dictation”**. Allow both:

Permission	Why it's needed
Microphone	To record your voice while you hold the key.
Input Monitoring	To notice when you press Right ⌥ / Right ⌘.

If no prompt appears, turn them on manually: **System Settings → Privacy & Security → Microphone** and **→ Input Monitoring**, switch on **Voice Dictation**.

Then **restart the app once**: right-click its icon in the Dock → **Quit**, then open it again with ⌘ **Space** → “Voice Dictation”.

5 Test it

Open Notes (or any text field). **Hold Right ⌥**, say a sentence, **release**. You hear a short sound; about a second later press **⌘V** — your sentence appears. Try **Right ⌘** with a Hungarian sentence too.

6 Optional: start automatically at login

Paste this into Terminal once:

```
cd ~/voice-dictation && ./autostart.sh
```

To turn it off again: `cd ~/voice-dictation && ./autostart.sh off`

That's it — you can close Terminal now.

Everyday use

To…	Do this
Open the app	⌘ **Space** → type “Voice Dictation” → **Enter**. Tip: drag it into the Dock for one-click start.
Dictate	Hold **Right ⌥** (English) or **Right ⌘** (Hungarian), speak, release, then **⌘V**.
Close the app	Right-click its Dock icon → **Quit** (or the microphone icon in the menu bar → **Quit**).
See the hotkeys	Click the Dock icon while it's running.

Re-copy an earlier text	Menu-bar microphone icon → **Recent** → click an entry.
Turn sounds on/off	Menu-bar microphone icon → **Sounds**.

Good to know

• **Hold the key for at least half a second.** Very short taps are ignored on purpose.

• Using the key in a shortcut (e.g. Right ⌘ + C) cancels the recording — normal shortcuts keep working.

• **Memory:** while open the app uses about 2.3 GB. After 10 minutes without dictation it frees most of it; the next dictation then takes a few seconds longer. When the app is closed it uses nothing.

• The menu-bar icon may be hidden behind the notch if your menu bar is full. The app works without it.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Nothing happens when I hold the key	Input Monitoring isn't allowed. System Settings → Privacy & Security → Input Monitoring → switch on Voice Dictation. Then quit and reopen the app.
Paste gives old text / nothing	Microphone isn't allowed (Privacy & Security → Microphone), or the key was held too briefly. Hold it the whole time you speak.
Another dictation app reacts too	Apps like Wispr Flow or macOS Dictation may use the same keys. Change their shortcut in their settings.
“Python 3.10+ not found” or other install error	Run the step 2 command again. If it still fails, send the Terminal output to whoever shared this app with you.
Anything else	Send the log: paste `tail -30 ~/Library/Logs/VoiceDictation.log` into Terminal and share the output.

Updating and uninstalling

Get the latest version:

```
cd ~/voice-dictation && git pull && ./install.sh
```

Remove the app completely (quit it first):

```
cd ~/voice-dictation && ./autostart.sh off
rm -rf ~/voice-dictation ~/Applications/"Voice Dictation.app"
rm -rf ~/.cache/huggingface/hub/models--mlx-community--whisper-large-v3-turbo
```

Source code: github.com/zsocavagyok/voice-dictation